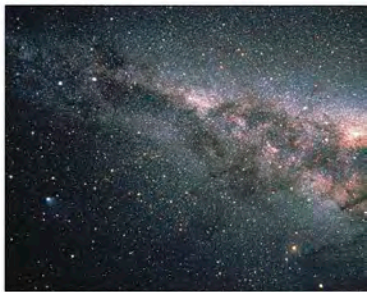


STARS AND GALAXIES



Stars look like tiny points of light from Earth but really they are huge, hot balls of burning gas deep in space. They are forming, changing, and dying all the time. There are big stars called giants, even bigger ones called supergiants, and small ones called dwarf stars. Our sun is just one of about a hundred thousand million stars that all belong to a galaxy called the Milky Way. A galaxy is a group of millions of stars, held together by a strong force called gravity.



Starry, starry night

On a clear night do not forget to look up at the sky! You will see hundreds of twinkling stars, like tiny sparkling diamonds, far above you.

The gas and dust pack tightly together, getting smaller and very hot.

A new star is very bright. It shines steadily for many years.

As it cools, the star gets bigger and forms a red giant.

Near the end of its life the core of a red giant may cave in and give off layers of gas.

A group of growing stars is called a cluster.

A star is born inside a large cloud of dust and gas, called a nebula. The word nebula means mist.

Sky lights

There are many new stars in the gas and dust of this pink nebula. A new young star on its own shines blue.

